PENINSULAR INDIA: PALLAVAS, CHALUKYAS & BRAHMANIZATION

PENINSULAR CHRONOLOGY AND POLITICAL → EVIDENCE AND SOURCE CRITICISM → PALLAVA AND CHALUKYA RULER → KANCHI-VATAPI RIVALRY AND REGIONAL → ADMINISTRATION AND LOCAL INSTITUTIONS → LAND GRANTS AND BRAHMANIZATION

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g7 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 PENINSULAR CHRONOLOGY AND POLITICAL GEOGRAPHY

- PENINSULAR CHRONOLOGY AND POLITICAL GEOGRAPHY
- C. 535 CE
- INDEPENDENT BADAMI CHALUKYA POWER CONSOLIDATES LATE 6TH C.
- SIMHAVISHNU RENEWS PALLAVA EXPANSION EARLY 7TH C.
- MAHENDRAVARMAN I AND PULAKESHIN II C. 630S
- NARMADA CHECK ON HARSHA C. 642
- NARASIMHAVARMAN I CAPTURES VATAPI
- 8TH C.

535 CE → independent Badami Chalukya power consolidates late 6th c. → **→ Simhavishnu renews Pallava expansion early 7th c.** → **→ Mahendravarman I and Pulakeshin II c.** → **630s → Narmada check on Harsha c.** → **642 → Narasimhavarman I captures Vatapi**

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- 535 CE → independent Badami Chalukya power consolidates late 6th c.
- → Simhavishnu renews Pallava expansion early 7th c.

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- → Mahendravarman I and Pulakeshin II c.
- 630s → Narmada check on Harsha c.

IMPACT / LIMIT

- 642 → Narasimhavarman I captures Vatapi
- 8th c. → Vikramaditya II, Rajasimha legacy and mature temple patronage c. 753 → Rashtrakutas end Badami line; Pallavas survive to c. 893.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 8th c. → Vikramaditya II, Rajasimha legacy and mature temple patronage c. 753 → Rashtrakutas end Badami line; Pallavas survive to c. 893.

01

STAGE 01 EVIDENCE AND SOURCE CRITICISM MATRIX

- EVIDENCE AND SOURCE CRITICISM MATRIX
- AIHOLE PRASHASTI
- GENEALOGY AND CAMPAIGNS
- ROYAL EXAGGERATION
- PALLAVA CHARTERS
- GRANTS AND LEGITIMATION
- FORMULAIC CLAIMS
- SANSKRIT + TAMIL EPIGRAPHY

AIHOLE PRASHASTI → genealogy and campaigns	royal exaggeration
PALLAVA CHARTERS → grants and legitimation	formulaic claims
MONUMENTS → patronage, technique and cult	attribution limits
LITERATURE → court, satire and devotion	genre and redaction
PORT / SETTLEMENT ARCHAEOLOGY → exchange	uneven survival

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- AIHOLE PRASHASTI → genealogy and campaigns
- royal exaggeration
- PALLAVA CHARTERS → grants and legitimation
- formulaic claims

METHOD / DEBATE

- SANSKRIT + TAMIL EPIGRAPHY → praise and documentary practice
- MONUMENTS → patronage, technique and cult
- attribution limits
- LITERATURE → court, satire and devotion

HISTORICAL RESULT

- genre and redaction
- PORT / SETTLEMENT ARCHAEOLOGY → exchange
- uneven survival
- RULE: monument first, style label later; inscription data plus ideology.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: monument first, style label later; inscription data plus ideology.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: monument first, style label later; inscription data plus ideology.

02

STAGE 02 PALLAVA AND CHALUKYA RULER LADDERS

- PALLAVA AND CHALUKYA RULER LADDERS
- PALLAVA CHALUKYA OF BADAMI
- SIMHAVISHNU PULAKESHIN I
- MAHENDRAVARMAN I KIRTIVARMAN I
- NARASIMHAVARMAN I MAMALLA MANGALESHA
- PARAMESVARAVARMAN I PULAKESHIN II
- NARASIMHAVARMAN II RAJASIMHA VIKRAMADITYA I
- NANDIVARMAN LINE FALL TO RASHTRAKUTAS

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
PALLAVA CHALUKYA OF BADAMI	Narasimhavarman I Mamalla Mangalesha	Nandivarman line fall to Rashtrakutas
Simhavishnu Pulakeshin I	Paramesvaravarman I Pulakeshin II	ANCHORS: Kanchi-Mamallapuram
Mahendravarman I Kirtivarman I	Narasimhavarman II Rajasimha Vikramaditya I / II	

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- PALLAVA CHALUKYA OF BADAMI
- Simhavishnu Pulakeshin I
- Mahendravarman I Kirtivarman I

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Narasimhavarman I Mamalla Mangalesha
- Paramesvaravarman I Pulakeshin II
- Narasimhavarman II Rajasimha Vikramaditya I / II

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Nandivarman line fall to Rashtrakutas
- ANCHORS: Kanchi-Mamallapuram

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nandivarman line fall to Rashtrakutas; ANCHORS: Kanchi-Mamallapuram | Vatapi-Aihole-Pattadakal.

03

STAGE 03 KANCHI-VATAPI RIVALRY AND REGIONAL EFFECTS

- KANCHI-VATAPI RIVALRY AND REGIONAL EFFECTS
- KANCHI <→ VENGI
- DECCAN ROUTES <→ VATAPI
- PULAKESHIN II EXPANDS EAST AND CHECKS HARSHA
- MAHENDRAVARMAN-PULAKESHIN CONFLICT
- NARASIMHAVARMAN I CAPTURES VATAPI
- VATAPIKONDA MEMORY LATER CHALUKYA VICTORIES AT KANCHI
- VIRUPAKSHA COMMEMORATION

KANCHI <→ VENGI / DECCAN ROUTES <→ VATAPI

Pulakeshin II expands east and checks Harsha → **Mahendravarman-Pulakeshin conflict** → **Narasimhavarman I captures Vatapi → Vatapikonda memory later Chalukya victories at Kanchi → Virupaksha commemoration**

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- KANCHI <→ VENGI / DECCAN ROUTES <→ VATAPI
- Pulakeshin II expands east and checks Harsha

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Mahendravarman-Pulakeshin conflict
- Narasimhavarman I captures Vatapi → Vatapikonda memory later Chalukya victories at Kanchi → Virupaksha commemoration

DEBATE / LEGACY

- RESULT: rivalry reshaped frontiers, branches, prestige and sacred landscapes.
- KANCHI <→ VENGI / DECCAN ROUTES <→ VATAPI

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RESULT: rivalry reshaped frontiers, branches, prestige and sacred landscapes.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: rivalry reshaped frontiers, branches, prestige and sacred landscapes.

04

STAGE 04 ADMINISTRATION AND LOCAL INSTITUTIONS

- ADMINISTRATION AND LOCAL INSTITUTIONS
- MILITARY ELITE
- TERRITORIAL OFFICERS AND REVENUE RIGHTS
- GRANTS TO BRAHMANAS AND RELIGIOUS INSTITUTIONS
- PEASANT VILLAGE
- BRAHMANA ASSEMBLY IN GRANT VILLAGE
- MERCHANT-LINKED SETTLEMENT
- PROMINENT VILLAGE ELDERS IN CHALUKYA RECORDS

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- KING / COURT / MILITARY ELITE
- territorial officers and revenue rights
- grants to Brahmanas and religious institutions

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- ur: peasant village
- sabha: Brahmana assembly in grant village
- nagaram: merchant-linked settlement

DEBATE / LEGACY

- mahajana: prominent village elders in Chalukya records
- CAUTION: do not project mature later Chola committee detail backward.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION: do not project mature later Chola committee detail backward.

05

STAGE 05 LAND GRANTS AND BRAHMANIZATION

- LAND GRANTS AND BRAHMANIZATION
- ROYAL CHARTER
- REVENUE RIGHTS + EXEMPTIONS + JURISDICTION
- DONEE INSERTION INTO SETTLED OR EXPANDING AGRARIAN ZONES
- CULTIVATION + SANSKRITIC LEGITIMACY + CASTE ORDERING
- RECIPROCAL RESHAPING OF LOCAL CULTS AND BRAHMANICAL PRACTICE
- USEFUL MODEL
- INTEGRATION AND HIERARCHY TOGETHER

ROYAL CHARTER → brahmadeya / agrahara → **revenue rights + exemptions + jurisdiction** → **donee insertion into settled or expanding agrarian zones** → **cultivation + Sanskritic legitimacy + caste ordering** → **reciprocal reshaping of local cults and Brahmanical practice**

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- ROYAL CHARTER → brahmadeya / agrahara
- revenue rights + exemptions + jurisdiction
- donee insertion into settled or expanding agrarian zones

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- cultivation + Sanskritic legitimacy + caste ordering
- reciprocal reshaping of local cults and Brahmanical practice
- USEFUL MODEL: integration and hierarchy together

DEBATE / LEGACY

- LIMIT: not every grant created a new village or proved royal weakness.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT: not every grant created a new village or proved royal weakness.

06

STAGE 06 BHAKTI AND RELIGIOUS PLURALITY

- BHAKTI AND RELIGIOUS PLURALITY
- VAISHNAVA HYMNS, SHRINE ROUTES AND EMOTIONAL DEVOTION
- SHAIVA HYMNS, SACRED PLACES AND COMMUNITY MEMORY
- RITUAL + LANDED PATRONAGE + POLITICAL VISIBILITY
- BUDDHIST GROUPS
- CONTINUED DEBATE, INSTITUTIONS AND COURT PRESENCE
- INCLUSION STORIES
- NANDANAR, TIRUPPAN ALVAR AND ANDAL

ALVARS → Vaishnava hymns, shrine routes and emotional devotion → **NAYANARS → Shaiva hymns, sacred places and community memory** → **TEMPLES → ritual + landed patronage + political visibility** → **JAIN / BUDDHIST GROUPS → continued debate, institutions and court presence** → **INCLUSION STORIES → Nandanar, Tiruppan Alvar and Andal**

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- ALVARS → Vaishnava hymns, shrine routes and emotional devotion
- NAYANARS → Shaiva hymns, sacred places and community memory
- TEMPLES → ritual + landed patronage + political visibility

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- JAIN / BUDDHIST GROUPS → continued debate, institutions and court presence
- INCLUSION STORIES → Nandanar, Tiruppan Alvar and Andal
- LIMIT: devotional access did not abolish caste, patriarchy or elite power

DEBATE / LEGACY

- VERDICT: vernacular opening within a hierarchical religious field.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT: vernacular opening within a hierarchical religious field.

07

STAGE 07 PALLAVA ARCHITECTURE TRAJECTORY

- PALLAVA ARCHITECTURE TRAJECTORY
- MAHENDRAVARMAN I
- ROCK-CUT CAVES
- MANDAGAPATTU, MAMANDUR
- NARASIMHAVARMAN I
- MAMALLAPURAM RATHAS AND GREAT RELIEFS
- SHORE TEMPLE + KAILASANATHA STRUCTURAL PHASE
- LATER PALLAVAS

MAHENDRAVARMAN I → rock-cut caves: Mandagapattu, Mamandur → **NARASIMHAVARMAN I → Mamallapuram rathas and great reliefs** → **RAJASIMHA → Shore Temple + Kailasanatha structural phase** → **LATER PALLAVAS → Vaikuntha Perumal and continuing Kanchi patronage** → **TECHNIQUE: cave → monolith → structural temple, with overlap**

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- MAHENDRAVARMAN I → rock-cut caves: Mandagapattu, Mamandur
- NARASIMHAVARMAN I → Mamallapuram rathas and great reliefs
- RAJASIMHA → Shore Temple + Kailasanatha structural phase

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- LATER PALLAVAS → Vaikuntha Perumal and continuing Kanchi patronage
- TECHNIQUE: cave → monolith → structural temple, with overlap
- MEANING: ritual experiment + royal image + coastal sacred landscape

IMPACT / LIMIT

- RULE: sequence is analytical, not a crude progress ladder.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: sequence is analytical, not a crude progress ladder.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: sequence is analytical, not a crude progress ladder.

08

STAGE 08 CHALUKYA ARCHITECTURE AND VESARA CAUTION

- CHALUKYA ARCHITECTURE AND VESARA CAUTION
- VARIED STRUCTURAL EXPERIMENTS AND PLANS
- CAVES, CAPITAL LANDSCAPE AND EARLY STRUCTURAL WORK
- NORTHERN AND SOUTHERN SUPERSTRUCTURE FORMS SIDE BY SIDE
- DRAVIDA FORM, LOKAMAHADEVI AND VICTORY MEMORY
- COMPARISON POINT FOR MIXED FORMAL VOCABULARY
- DURGA TEMPLE
- APSIDAL PLAN; NAME DOES NOT PROVE DURGA DEDICATION

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
AIHOLE → varied structural experiments and plans	VIRUPAKSHA → Dravida form, Lokamahadevi and victory memory	VESARA: modern shorthand only after site-specific description.
BADAMI → caves, capital landscape and early structural work	PAPANATHA → comparison point for mixed formal vocabulary	
PATTADAKAL → northern and southern superstructure forms side by side	DURGA TEMPLE → apsidal plan; name does not prove Durga dedication	

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- AIHOLE → varied structural experiments and plans
- BADAMI → caves, capital landscape and early structural work
- PATTADAKAL → northern and southern superstructure forms side by side

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- VIRUPAKSHA → Dravida form, Lokamahadevi and victory memory
- PAPANATHA → comparison point for mixed formal vocabulary
- DURGA TEMPLE → apsidal plan; name does not prove Durga dedication

DEBATE / LEGACY

- VESARA: modern shorthand only after site-specific description.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DURGA TEMPLE → apsidal plan; name does not prove Durga dedication.

09

STAGE 09 ART, LITERATURE AND BILINGUAL COURT CULTURE

- ART, LITERATURE AND BILINGUAL COURT CULTURE
- SOMASKANDA, SHAIVA-VAISHNAVA PROGRAMMES
- BADAMI EVIDENCE WITH SURVIVAL AND ATTRIBUTION LIMITS
- PRASHASTI, COURT LITERATURE AND MATTAVILASA-PRAHASANA
- DOCUMENTARY EPIGRAPHY AND DEVOTIONAL HYMN WORLDS
- LITERARY MEMORY WITH CONTEXT CAUTIONS
- MONUMENT + TEXT
- KINGSHIP COMMUNICATED THROUGH SEVERAL MEDIA

SCULPTURE / RELIEF → Somaskanda, Shaiva-Vaishnava programmes → **PAINTING → Badami evidence with survival and attribution limits** → **SANSKRIT → prashasti, court literature and Mattavilasa-prahasana** → **TAMIL → documentary epigraphy and devotional hymn worlds** → **DANDIN / NANDIKKALAMBAKAM → literary memory with context cautions**

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- SCULPTURE / RELIEF → Somaskanda, Shaiva-Vaishnava programmes
- PAINTING → Badami evidence with survival and attribution limits
- SANSKRIT → prashasti, court literature and Mattavilasa-prahasana

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- TAMIL → documentary epigraphy and devotional hymn worlds
- DANDIN / NANDIKKALAMBAKAM → literary memory with context cautions
- MONUMENT + TEXT → kingship communicated through several media

DEBATE / LEGACY

- 2024 GS-I ROUTE: art and literature must appear together.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 2024 GS-I ROUTE: art and literature must appear together.

10

STAGE 10 ECONOMY, PORTS AND BAY OF BENGAL LINKS

- ECONOMY, PORTS AND BAY OF BENGAL LINKS
- AGRARIAN SETTLEMENTS
- SURPLUS + TAXES + TEMPLE SUPPORT
- CRAFT CENTRES
- WEAVING, METAL, SCULPTURE AND BUILDING LABOUR
- POLITICAL, RELIGIOUS, LITERARY AND COMMERCIAL CENTRE
- COASTAL OUTLET AND PORT-HINTERLAND CONNECTION
- MERCHANT GROUPS

AGRARIAN SETTLEMENTS → surplus + taxes + temple support

CRAFT CENTRES → weaving, metal, sculpture and building labour → **KANCHI → political, religious, literary and commercial centre** → **MAMALLAPURAM → coastal outlet and port-hinterland connection**

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- AGRARIAN SETTLEMENTS → surplus + taxes + temple support
- CRAFT CENTRES → weaving, metal, sculpture and building labour
- KANCHI → political, religious, literary and commercial centre

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- MAMALLAPURAM → coastal outlet and port-hinterland connection
- MERCHANT GROUPS / NAGARAMS → inland and maritime circulation
- BAY OF BENGAL → exchange and cultural contact

DEBATE / LEGACY

- LIMIT: maritime connectivity is not proof of a Pallava overseas empire.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT: maritime connectivity is not proof of a Pallava overseas empire.

11

STAGE 11 PENINSULAR REGIONALISATION ANSWER SPINE

- PENINSULAR REGIONALISATION ANSWER SPINE
- C. 550-900 AS A FORMATIVE EARLY-MEDIEVAL TRANSITION
- PALLAVA-CHALUKYA RIVALRY + VENGI CONSEQUENCE
- GRANTS + UR/SABHA/NAGARAM + HIERARCHY
- BHAKTI + JAIN/BUDDHIST PLURALITY + SOCIAL LIMITS
- NAMED PALLAVA AND CHALUKYA SITES BEFORE STYLE LABELS
- KANCHI-MAMALLAPURAM AND SELECTIVE MARITIME VITALITY
- RIVALRY, LAND, SHRINES AND LANGUAGE ROOTED REGIONAL STATES.

OPEN → c. 550-900 as a formative early-medieval transition → **POLITY → Pallava-Chalukya rivalry + Vengi consequence** → **LOCALITY → grants + ur/sabha/nagaram + hierarchy** → **RELIGION → bhakti + Jain/Buddhist plurality + social limits** → **ART → named Pallava and Chalukya sites before style labels**

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- OPEN → c. 550-900 as a formative early-medieval transition
- POLITY → Pallava-Chalukya rivalry + Vengi consequence
- LOCALITY → grants + ur/sabha/nagaram + hierarchy

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- RELIGION → bhakti + Jain/Buddhist plurality + social limits
- ART → named Pallava and Chalukya sites before style labels
- ECONOMY → Kanchi-Mamallapuram and selective maritime vitality

DEBATE / LEGACY

- CLOSE → rivalry, land, shrines and language rooted regional states.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → rivalry, land, shrines and language rooted regional states.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

- OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT
- PENINSULAR INDIA
- PALLAVAS, CHALUKYAS & BRAHMANIZATION — ADVANCED
- 1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA
- 2. KEY CLASSIFICATION
- 3. STUDY LINKS
- 4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS)
- 5. UPSC TRAPS

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Peninsular India: Pallavas, Chalukyas & Brahmanization — ADVANCED
- Mini-timeline
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 3. Study links
- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link

LEGACY / NUANCE

- 7. Mains angles
- Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)
- Royal inscriptions are often eulogistic; the Aihole inscription is valuable but must be read as political praise.
- Chalukya-Pallava conflict involved shifting victories: Pulakeshin II advanced against the Pallavas, while Narasimhavarman I later retaliated.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels